

1. According to the Declaration of Independence, governments get their just powers from
0.25 Pts
the king.
Parliament.
the Church of England.
the consent of the governed.

2. Before declaring independence, the Second Continental Congress recommended that the colonies
replace their colonial governments with new state governments.
ask France for an alliance.
send the Olive Branch Petition to the king.
adopt the Articles of Confederation.

3. Britain gave the United States generous terms in 1783 mainly because it wanted to
keep France from regaining power in North America.
reward the Americans for staying neutral toward Spain.
win American help in a future war.
stop an American invasion of Canada.

4. Colonies with the highest share of enslaved people showed the least support for the Revolution
mainly because
planters feared losing their enslaved workers if the war went badly.
most enslaved people there were already free.
the British had banned slavery in those colonies.
those colonies had no militias.

5. During the peace talks in Paris, the American diplomats were told to follow France's lead but
instead
refused to negotiate at all.
asked Spain to take the lead.
let Congress write the treaty.
dealt with Britain directly, because France wanted a weak United States.

6. Fighting in the South was often

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limited to a few large battles between regular armies.

a brutal small-unit civil war between Loyalists and Patriots.

avoided by both sides until the war ended.

led by Spanish troops.

7. In the Declaration of Independence, each grievance beginning "He has..." refers to King George III.

Parliament.

the Continental Congress.

Lord Dunmore.

8. In the Declaration of the Causes and Necessity of Taking Up Arms (1775), the Second Continental Congress said the colonists were fighting for

complete independence from Britain.

an alliance with France.

seats in Parliament.

their rights as Englishmen.

9. Jefferson used "the pursuit of happiness" instead of Locke's word "property" because property belonged to the king under English law.

property sounded too economic for a statement of rights.

Franklin wanted a shorter phrase.

the southern delegates demanded it.

10. Many southerners during the war in the South were most willing to support the Patriots, because of the Declaration of Independence.

the British, because most were Loyalists.

whichever side could bring stability to their area.

the French, because of the alliance.

11. Spain got Florida back in 1783 because it

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was a formal ally of the United States.

bought it from the United States.

had fought Britain, and Britain did not want to run Florida anyway.

had never lost it in 1763.

12. The American victory at Saratoga mattered most because it

ended the war in the North.

forced Britain to recognize American independence.

led France to ally openly with the United States.

gave the Patriots control of Canada.

13. The First Continental Congress sent the Declaration of Rights and Grievances mainly to

protest the Coercive Acts and defend the colonists' rights as Englishmen.

announce that the colonies were independent.

form an alliance with France.

approve the Articles of Confederation.

14. The Olive Branch Petition (1775) was

a declaration of independence sent to Parliament.

a peace offer to King George III, who refused even to recognize it.

a plan for a Continental Army.

a treaty with France.

15. The Second Continental Congress differed from the First Continental Congress in that the Second

met only to answer the Coercive Acts.

refused to raise an army.

was elected by Parliament.

met after fighting began and acted as a wartime government.

16. The winter at Valley Forge mattered because

0.25 Pts

European officers trained the army into a professional force.

the army won its first battle there.

Congress moved there from Philadelphia.

the French army joined Washington there.

17. Thomas Jefferson was chosen to write the Declaration of Independence mainly because

he was the oldest member of the committee.

he had written Common Sense.

he was considered the best writer on the committee.

he was the only Virginian in the Congress.

18. Thomas Paine argued in Common Sense that America's advantages included

its powerful navy and professional army.

its distance from England, its land, and its size.

the support of every colonist.

its alliance with Spain.

19. Under the Franco-American Alliance, France sent the United States

a loan to pay off debts to British merchants.

control of Canada.

settlers for the western lands.

troops, military advisors, gunpowder and a naval fleet.

20. Under the Treaty of Paris (1783), Loyalists whose land had been confiscated

received full payment from Congress.

could use American courts to try to get it back, but almost none succeeded.

were given land in the Northwest instead.

could return only if they paid a fine.

21. Which of the following was a provision of the Treaty of Paris (1783)?

0.25 Pts

Britain kept the land west of the Appalachians.

France received Canada.

The United States gave up fishing off Newfoundland.

Britain agreed to leave its forts in the Northwest.

22. Which of the following was an important difference between the Treaty of Paris of 1763 and the Treaty of Paris of 1783?

The 1763 treaty gave the colonies independence; the 1783 treaty ended the French and Indian War.

The 1763 treaty set the border at the Rocky Mountains; the 1783 treaty set it at the Appalachians.

The 1763 treaty removed France from North America; the 1783 treaty recognized American independence.

The 1763 treaty gave Florida to Spain; the 1783 treaty gave Florida to Britain.

23. Answer (a), (b), and (c).

1 Pts

(a) Briefly describe ONE way the goals of the Second Continental Congress changed between 1775 and 1776.

(b) Briefly explain ONE cause of that change.

(c) Briefly explain ONE way the Declaration of Independence justified the break with Britain.

Answer Key

1. According to the Declaration of Independence, governments get their just powers from

0.25 Pts

the king.

Parliament.

the Church of England.

the consent of the governed.

Why: Power comes from the people; if a government destroys their rights, they may change it.

2. Before declaring independence, the Second Continental Congress recommended that the colonies

replace their colonial governments with new state governments.

ask France for an alliance.

send the Olive Branch Petition to the king.

adopt the Articles of Confederation.

Why: The Articles came later; the Olive Branch came earlier.

3. Britain gave the United States generous terms in 1783 mainly because it wanted to

keep France from regaining power in North America.

reward the Americans for staying neutral toward Spain.

win American help in a future war.

stop an American invasion of Canada.

Why: Britain hated France more than it hated America.

4. Colonies with the highest share of enslaved people showed the least support for the Revolution mainly because

planters feared losing their enslaved workers if the war went badly.

most enslaved people there were already free.

the British had banned slavery in those colonies.

those colonies had no militias.

Why: If the Patriots lost, Britain might free the enslaved, and that was where southern wealth was tied up.

5. During the peace talks in Paris, the American diplomats were told to follow France's lead but instead

0.25 Pts

refused to negotiate at all.

asked Spain to take the lead.

let Congress write the treaty.

dealt with Britain directly, because France wanted a weak United States.

Why: France hated Britain more than it liked America, so the diplomats went around it.

6. Fighting in the South was often

limited to a few large battles between regular armies.

a brutal small-unit civil war between Loyalists and Patriots.

avoided by both sides until the war ended.

led by Spanish troops.

Why: Neighbors fought neighbors, and most people sided with whoever brought stability.

7. In the Declaration of Independence, each grievance beginning "He has..." refers to

King George III.

Parliament.

the Continental Congress.

Lord Dunmore.

Why: The colonists held that Parliament never had power over them; the king let it violate their rights.

8. In the Declaration of the Causes and Necessity of Taking Up Arms (1775), the Second Continental Congress said the colonists were fighting for

complete independence from Britain.

an alliance with France.

seats in Parliament.

their rights as Englishmen.

Why: 1775 is rights as Englishmen; 1776 is independence.

9. Jefferson used "the pursuit of happiness" instead of Locke's word "property" because

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property belonged to the king under English law.

property sounded too economic for a statement of rights.

Franklin wanted a shorter phrase.

the southern delegates demanded it.

Why: The reason given is that property sounded too economic.

10. Many southerners during the war in the South were most willing to support the Patriots, because of the Declaration of Independence.

the British, because most were Loyalists.

whichever side could bring stability to their area.

the French, because of the alliance.

Why: After years of raids and executions, order mattered more than the cause.

11. Spain got Florida back in 1783 because it was a formal ally of the United States.

bought it from the United States.

had fought Britain, and Britain did not want to run Florida anyway.

had never lost it in 1763.

Why: Spain fought Britain but was never a U.S. ally; Britain did not want to govern Florida, and Spain was weak.

12. The American victory at Saratoga mattered most because it ended the war in the North.

forced Britain to recognize American independence.

led France to ally openly with the United States.

gave the Patriots control of Canada.

Why: Independence was recognized only in the Treaty of Paris (1783).

13. The First Continental Congress sent the Declaration of Rights and Grievances mainly to

0.25 Pts

protest the Coercive Acts and defend the colonists' rights as Englishmen.

announce that the colonies were independent.

form an alliance with France.

approve the Articles of Confederation.

Why: It still asked for rights inside the empire; independence came in 1776.

14. The Olive Branch Petition (1775) was

a declaration of independence sent to Parliament.

a peace offer to King George III, who refused even to recognize it.

a plan for a Continental Army.

a treaty with France.

Why: It still called the colonists the king's loyal subjects. Independence came a year later.

15. The Second Continental Congress differed from the First Continental Congress in that the Second met only to answer the Coercive Acts.

refused to raise an army.

was elected by Parliament.

met after fighting began and acted as a wartime government.

Why: The First answered the Coercive Acts; the Second ran the war.

16. The winter at Valley Forge mattered because

European officers trained the army into a professional force.

the army won its first battle there.

Congress moved there from Philadelphia.

the French army joined Washington there.

Why: The army that came out in the spring could fight like regulars.

17. Thomas Jefferson was chosen to write the Declaration of Independence mainly because

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he was the oldest member of the committee.

he had written Common Sense.

he was considered the best writer on the committee.

he was the only Virginian in the Congress.

Why: Adams pushed for him as the strongest writer. Paine wrote Common Sense.

18. Thomas Paine argued in Common Sense that America's advantages included

its powerful navy and professional army.

its distance from England, its land, and its size.

the support of every colonist.

its alliance with Spain.

Why: Paine saw the ocean and the continent itself as strengths.

19. Under the Franco-American Alliance, France sent the United States

a loan to pay off debts to British merchants.

control of Canada.

settlers for the western lands.

troops, military advisors, gunpowder and a naval fleet.

Why: France turned a colonial revolt into a war with a European power.

20. Under the Treaty of Paris (1783), Loyalists whose land had been confiscated

received full payment from Congress.

could use American courts to try to get it back, but almost none succeeded.

were given land in the Northwest instead.

could return only if they paid a fine.

Why: The states had sold the land to Patriots, so courts gave almost none of it back.

21. Which of the following was a provision of the Treaty of Paris (1783)?

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Britain kept the land west of the Appalachians.

France received Canada.

The United States gave up fishing off Newfoundland.

Britain agreed to leave its forts in the Northwest.

Why: Britain kept those forts for years anyway.

22. Which of the following was an important difference between the Treaty of Paris of 1763 and the Treaty of Paris of 1783?

The 1763 treaty gave the colonies independence; the 1783 treaty ended the French and Indian War.

The 1763 treaty set the border at the Rocky Mountains; the 1783 treaty set it at the Appalachians.

The 1763 treaty removed France from North America; the 1783 treaty recognized American independence.

The 1763 treaty gave Florida to Spain; the 1783 treaty gave Florida to Britain.

Why: Both put a boundary on the Mississippi. Florida went to Spain in 1783.

23. Answer (a), (b), and (c).

(a) Briefly describe ONE way the goals of the Second Continental Congress changed between 1775 and 1776.

In 1775 the Congress fought to restore the colonists' rights as Englishmen, but by 1776 it sought independence. The Declaration of the Causes and Necessity of Taking Up Arms promised to lay down arms once rights were restored, while the Declaration of Independence cut ties with Britain.

(b) Briefly explain ONE cause of that change.

King George III's refusal to recognize the Olive Branch Petition showed that reconciliation was impossible, and Paine's Common Sense convinced many colonists to accept a full break.

(c) Briefly explain ONE way the Declaration of Independence justified the break with Britain.

The Declaration argued that governments get their just powers from the consent of the governed and exist to protect unalienable rights. Because its grievances showed King George III violating those rights, the colonists claimed the right to alter or abolish his government.